

Rajesh Dammala

Production Support Engineer (AVP) — Incident Management, Automation & Reliability

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Morrisville, NC (Cary-area; hybrid on-site ready)

https://rdammala.github.io/Deutsche-Bank_Production-Support-Engineer/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Production support engineer and reliability leader with 16+ years in controlled, SLA-driven enterprise environments operating within ITIL-aligned incident, problem, and change management. Deep UNIX/Linux and Windows operations, automation (Python, Shell, PowerShell, Ansible-class), and cloud/IaC (GCP, Azure, GitHub, Terraform). Skilled in monitoring/alerting, Secrets Management, security/endpoint tooling, and database querying (Oracle, MS SQL). Strong communicator who translates technical issues for non-technical stakeholders and thrives in global, follow-the-sun teams.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Owned incident management to strict KPI/SLA/MTTR targets across a 24/7/365 follow-the-sun platform; 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Automation-first: eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; lifted efficiency 85%!98%.
- Reduced resolution time 32% through escalation redesign and proactive monitoring/alerting.
- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution.
- Maintained 99.95%+ availability at data-center scale across UNIX/Linux and Windows production.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Production Support & ITIL: Incident Management, Problem & Change Management, ITIL-aligned Operations, KPI / SLA / MTTR, Post-Incident Review (RCA)

Automation & Scripting: Python, Shell / Bash, PowerShell, Ansible (config-as-code patterns), Toil Reduction

Cloud & IaC: GCP, Microsoft Azure, Terraform, GitHub / Git workflows, Secrets Management / KeyVault

Monitoring & Data: Monitoring & Alerting, Kusto (KQL), Power BI, Oracle, MS SQL

Platforms & OS: UNIX / Linux, Windows, ServiceNow, Security / EDR / Endpoint tooling

Ways of Working: DevOps, Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Agile, Follow-the-Sun Support, Financial Services Operations

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Incident Management & RCA (ITIL-aligned) — **Expert**
Production Support (UNIX/Linux & Windows) — **Advanced**
Automation (Python, Shell, PowerShell, Ansible-class) — **Expert**
Monitoring & Alerting — **Expert**
GCP / Azure — **Advanced**
GitHub / Terraform IaC workflows — **Advanced**
Secrets Management & Security/EDR tooling — **Advanced**
Oracle / MS SQL querying — **Advanced**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Production Support & Reliability Engineer — Xbox Services (SRE)

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Level-2/3 production support and incident leadership for a 24/7/365 follow-the-sun, mission-critical platform.

- Own incident management end-to-end — identification, impact assessment, stakeholder communication, escalation, and post-incident review — meeting strict KPI, SLA, and MTTR targets.
- Operate within ITIL-aligned processes and Key Operating Procedures across incident, problem, and change management using ServiceNow/ICM-class tooling.
- Deployed and enhanced monitoring and alerting to proactively detect and resolve application issues; built KQL/Power BI dashboards for service health.
- Drove automation with PowerShell and Python (Ansible-class config patterns), eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and lifting efficiency 85%!98%.
- Partnered with engineering teams to onboard support for new applications and ensure production readiness; managed secrets/KeyVault (Secrets Management) onboarding.
- Supported security/endpoint platforms and CI/CD via Git and Terraform-class IaC workflows in a controlled production environment.

Azure Production Support Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Led a 15-engineer team supporting enterprise applications in controlled production environments.

- Managed incidents, problems, and changes in an SLA-driven enterprise environment; owned high-impact escalations to resolution.
- Diagnosed complex application, configuration, and networking issues across cloud and hybrid infrastructure.
- Worked with databases and data querying (SQL Server, Azure SQL) to triage and resolve production issues.
- Coordinated with global, distributed teams across time zones in a follow-the-sun support model.

Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating UNIX/Linux and Windows production services at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Maintained high availability of critical services through deep cluster-to-blade investigations and change management.
- Built PowerShell/Shell automation and scripts for daily operations, saving thousands of manual hours annually.

- Led patch, hotfix, and upgrade rollouts affecting millions of workloads with zero incidents; ITIL-aligned operations.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

UNIX/Linux and Windows production infrastructure support.

- Server builds, decommissions, cluster configuration, and large-scale data migrations across RHEL/Windows.
- Applied patches, hotfixes, and service packs; scripted repetitive operational tasks.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

Incident & Post-Mortem Discipline — Standardized impact assessment, stakeholder comms, escalation, and RCA to consistently meet KPI/SLA/MTTR in a controlled production environment.

Automation-First Operations — Built Python/Shell/PowerShell automation (Ansible-class patterns) for daily operations, eliminating 25,000+ incidents and thousands of manual hours.

Proactive Monitoring & Alerting — Deployed and tuned monitoring/alerting and KQL/Power BI dashboards to detect and resolve issues before customer impact.

Secure Production Onboarding — Onboarded new applications for production readiness with Secrets Management, Git/Terraform workflows, and security/endpoint tooling.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt
- ITIL-aligned operations (hands-on, not certified)

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Reliability is earned through discipline: own the incident, automate the toil, instrument everything, and communicate clearly under pressure. I bring an automation-first, service-improvement mindset to controlled production environments.